

Before You Vote: A Take-Home Checklist

Six checks you can run on any candidate, in any race, using free public records.

1. Read the conflict-of-interest form, then check it

- Find it on the county COI page **and** inside the Declaration of Candidacy packet.
- Search the candidate's name at businessregistration.utah.gov.
- Compare with their own bio, website, and posts. Do the boards and businesses match?
- The Wasatch form asks what the filer *believes* could be a conflict. Ask: was that a reasonable call?

2. Follow the money

- County races: county Election page. Legislative races: disclosures.utah.gov.
- People or organizations? Local or outside? Money right after a primary?
- Look up any PAC's own report: who runs it, and where its money came from.

3. Look for a record from before the campaign

- Meeting minutes and votes, hearing comments, letters to the editor, past board service.

4. Map the boards and roles

- Which boards do they sit on, and who appointed them?
- Do those boards come before the council? Will they disclose and step aside?

5. Compare what they say with what the record shows

- Treat a candidate's description of their own record as a claim until it matches minutes or filings.

6. Ask the five questions

- **Power:** Will you add a check on decisions the public has no say over?
- **Transparency:** Will you disclose conflicts in writing and out loud before votes?
- **Financial accountability:** On TIF, PIDs, and no-bid contracts — who pays, and will you show the numbers?
- **Environmental impact:** Do water, wetlands, and open space count as a real limit?
- **Community impact:** Who bears the cost of growth, and do residents get real standing?

Ask your county

- Call or email the Wasatch County Clerk/Auditor: 435-657-3190, ClerkAuditor@wasatch.utah.gov.
- State law (Utah Code §17-70-304) says the county's form needs a separate section for each item: employers now and last year, businesses you own or run, income over \$5,000, stocks and bonds over \$5,000, boards, your spouse's job, and household members. Ours has one question. Ask why.
- The law says the clerk may not accept a declaration of candidacy without a complete statement. Ask where Robert McNeill's statement is; his declaration was accepted Sept. 1.
- Ask for clearer questions, too: relatives in Utah politics or doing business with the county, and whether each item comes before the county.

Cautions

- Check the date on everything — board lists and websites go stale.
- Not finding a record is not proof it doesn't exist. Look at the actual page.
- Social media is a lead, not a source.

Where to look

wasatchcounty.gov/275 — filings, finance reports, sample ballots
wasatchcounty.gov/276 — conflict-of-interest forms
disclosures.utah.gov
businessregistration.utah.gov
midaut.org/board-members
vote.utah.gov · judges.utah.gov

Wasatch voting dates

Oct. 13 — ballots mailed, drop boxes open
Oct. 27–30 — early voting, 9 a.m.–4 p.m., 25 N. Main, Heber City
Nov. 3 — 7 a.m.–8 p.m., County Administration Building (only polling place). Drop boxes close 8 p.m.
Bring ID.